

Cleaned Highlighted Notes

Article: Andrews, D. A., Bonta, J., & Wormith, J. S. (2011). *The Risk-Need-Responsivity (RNR) Model: Does Adding the Good Lives Model Contribute to Effective Crime Prevention?* Criminal Justice and Behavior, 38(7), 735-755. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0093854811406356>

Highlighted Passages by Page

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Quote 1: "With respect to offender treatment, interventions that adhere to the RNR principles are associated with significant reductions in recidivism, whereas treatments that fail to follow the principles yield minimal reductions in recidivism and, in some cases, even increase recidivism (Andrews & Bonta, 2010a, 2010b; Andrews, Zinger, et al., 1990)."

Quote 2: "The relevance of the principles also appears to apply to the treatment of sexual offenders (Hanson, Bourgon, Helmus, & Hodgson, 2009). Although the list of principles has been expanded beyond the original ones described in 1990 (Andrews, 2001; Andrews & Bonta, 2010a; Bonta & Andrews, 2007, 2010), the principles of risk, need, and responsivity remain at the core and have exerted a considerable influence on correctional theory, practice, and policy."

Quote 3: "In 2003 Ward and Stewart criticized the concept of criminogenic needs for ignoring more basic human needs that underlie optimal personal fulfillment. They argued that attaining the basic goods of 'friendship, enjoyable work, loving relationships, creative pursuits, sexual satisfaction, positive self-regard, and an intellectually challenging environment' (p. 142) should be the primary goals for offender rehabilitation. Achieve these goals and reductions in criminogenic needs will follow."

Why this matters: These highlights capture the core setup of the article: RNR is presented as empirically supported, and GLM is framed as arguing that pursuit of broader human goods should come first.

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Quote 4: "At this point, the empirical support for GLM pales compared to that of RNR. The studies thus far have been limited to small samples or case studies (e.g., Whitehead, Ward, & Collie, 2007; Willis & Ward, 2010)."

Why this matters: This is one of the clearest evidence-based criticisms in the piece: the authors are saying GLM had not yet built a comparable empirical base.

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Quote 5: "GLM places considerable emphasis on the role of human motivation and agency in criminal behavior. This focus is presented as a key feature that apparently differentiates GLM from RNR. We beg to

differ on both empirical and theoretical grounds.”

Why this matters: This highlight shows the authors directly rejecting the claim that GLM meaningfully surpasses RNR on motivation and agency.

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Quote 6: “However, the studies cited as supportive of this link, as far as we can tell, are based on noncriminal populations.”

Quote 7: “Theoretically, GLM owes much to strain theory (Merton, 1957) and, if we go back further, to the Freudian frustration-aggression model of crime (Dollard, Doob, Miller, Mowrer, & Sears, 1939).”

Quote 8: “Indeed, the GPCSL perspective not only integrates frustration-aggression and strain theory but also gives due attention to self-regulation (a recent addition to GLM), personality, attitudes, associates, and criminal history.”

Why this matters: These highlights suggest two critiques: (1) GLM sometimes cites evidence from non-offender populations, and (2) elements GLM presents as distinctive may already be incorporated within the broader RNR/GPCSL framework.

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Quote 9: “When the GLM advocates are faced with translating the constructs into practice, they end up with treatment advice that closely resembles what we have been arguing for years. All of the strategies that they suggest, from concrete steps to establish relationships to teaching problem solving, have been used effectively by treatment providers and done so without the guidance of a theory of human needs.”

Quote 10: “This vision is quite bold: Criminal conduct will be prevented when an offender becomes more intrinsically motivated and more self-determined.”

Quote 11: “Our point is that targeting criminogenic needs is the more direct and less risky approach to reducing criminal behavior rather than by enhancing human goods.”

Quote 12: “Ward and Maruna’s (2007) admission that ‘simply seeking to increase well-being . . . may result in a happy but dangerous individual’ (p. 125).”

Why this matters: These highlights get at the heart of the article’s thesis: the authors view criminogenic-need targeting as the safer and more direct route, and they worry that a broad well-being focus can leave risk-relevant factors untouched.

Overall Theme of Your Highlights

Your highlights seem to focus on four main ideas:

1. RNR has the stronger empirical base.
2. GLM may overstate how different it is from RNR.
3. Enhancing well-being alone is not enough to reduce offending risk.
4. Targeting criminogenic needs is presented as the more direct, evidence-based correctional strategy.